donation of vast amounts of silver coins and mountains of grain, but, above all, huge numbers of cows – in one instance twenty thousand, but more usually the auspicious number of 1001.

Of the gods acknowledged at the start of the Naneghat inscription nearly all were Vedic – Dharma (lord of all creatures), Indra, Surya, Chandra, Yama, Varuna, Kubera and the four guardians of the quarters – but also mentioned were two manifestations of the same Hindu god now on the rise: Sankarshana (Vishnu as Balarama, older brother of Krishna) and Vasudeva (Vishnu as Krishna). Patently the author of the inscription saw her royal line as part of the Arya family, even though it was probably Dravidian in origin. The inscription named them as the Satavahanas.

None of the Hindu Puranas lists a royal dynasty named Satavahana, but five give details of the Andhras, a dynasty founded by a Raja Simuka, with many of his ruling descendants bearing the regnal name Satakarni. Emperor Ashoka in his major rock edicts had referred to just such a people called Andhra living within the southern borders of his empire. The Greek ambassador Megasthenes, who had attended the courts of Ashoka's grandfather and father, had also written in his *Indika* of a people he called 'Andarae', describing them as a 'powerful race, which possesses numerous villages, and thirty towns defended by walls and towers, and which supplies its king with an army of 100,000 infantry, 2000 cavalry, and 1000 elephants'. The Naneghat inscription names Simuka as the Satavahanas' founding father and Satakarni as his son, so patently the Satavahanas and the Andhras are one and the same, most probably originating in the region between the Krishna and Godavari rivers that still carries that name of Andhra to this day.

The *Matsya Purana* lists the name of thirty Satavahana kings who together ruled for a total of 460 years. Of these, ten carried the name Satakarni or a close approximation.